

19 CLICKS OF WEB SEPARATION

Every web page on the World Wide

Web is connected to every other page in under 19 clicks, according to a recent study. And there are about 14 billion web pages scattered across the Web. Go figure.

<http://dgit.in/Y7sd7n>

PRE-ORDER GOOGLE GLASS FOR \$1,500

The hotly anticipated Google Glass wearable tech gizmo

finally went up for pre-order, for an astonishingly high price at that. Google also released a new video detailing other cool features of the device.

<http://dgit.in/15v0sck>

HAVE CONSOLE GAMERS MOVED ON?

With Sony launching the PlayStation 4 after six

years, and Microsoft's Xbox refresh coming later this year, are console gamers waiting and watching or have they moved on to mobile gaming?

<http://dgit.in/12MDaiC>

MAGIC OF LIQUID CRYSTALLINITY

What do TV screens, bars of soaps, and bullet-proof

vests all have in common? The answer is liquid crystallinity. This article describes the physics behind the phenomenon and how it's applied in gadgets.

<http://dgit.in/XMlpHm>

Apple iWatch: A huge mistake?

- By James Plafke



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However impressive or sleek an iWatch would end up being, would it really be a good idea for Apple to get into the wrist-watch game?

Now, before you instantly discredit an iWatch rumor as just being a rumor that the news cycle created in order to have news to cycle, the report originated from the Wall Street Journal, and despite what you may or may not think about the publication, it has a great track record with Apple-related rumors. Reportedly, Apple has discussed the production of a smartwatch with one of its manufacturing partners, Hon Hai Precision Industry Co. — otherwise known as Foxconn — and would be adding some smartphone-like features into the device. The watch would be made out of curved glass that can form around the human body, and would run iOS.

The technology for a curved glass smartwatch has already been established. The sixth generation iPod Nano already fit an iOS-like (albeit simple) operating system into a wrist-sized device, and Gorilla Glass manufacturer Corning created Willow Glass, a bendable glass. Apple uses Corning's Gorilla Glass in its smartphones, so the two companies already have a working partnership.

Considering the other prominent tech scenes Apple has yet to enter — such as an actual TV, a dedicated gaming console, or even sprucing up its set-top streaming box



— jumping into the watch market would be odd. If the watch ran some iteration of iOS, then that'd still leave the device with a significantly tiny screen, as well as without the capability to make phone calls, or enough screen real estate to efficiently type text messages (or anything else, for that matter) on the device. Also, the company did allow its sixth generation iPod Nano to fasten to a strap so people could wear it like a watch. Now, the seventh generation iPod Nano departed from that design and went back to the rectangle; clearly, the watch idea didn't prove too popular. It would seem like a much better idea for Apple to just make a television already instead of take this detour into watch territory.

However, remember when the iPad was first announced, and everyone thought it was a redundant piece of technology that only tech people would adopt out of a sheer love for new tech? Well, everyone sure was wrong about that. So, if a smartwatch seems like a silly idea, so did the iPad once upon a time. On top that, the success of the Kickstarter-funded Pebble proves there is a

market for a smartwatch. In fact, it could be a handy little device. So analysts who're discrediting and dismissing an iWatch rumour, remember that history may (or may not) be repeating itself.

Though the screen of an iWatch would have to be smaller than a smartphone's, there's nothing stopping it from utilizing equally powerful hardware to perform tasks as well as a smartphone does. It's also possible that Apple could finagle cellular and data capability into the watch, not only giving consumers a (hopefully) stylish wrist accessory, but an alternative to droppable, bulkier-by-comparison smartphones. If this ended up being the case, the watch would need to be paired with a wireless headset, which has been a common accessory for a while. Also, if Apple could combined the curved glass with flexible display technology, the watch's screen could theoretically extend around the whole wrist, providing more real estate.

You could also call a smartwatch something of a trial run for Apple exploring the wearable computing sector. With Google Glass somewhere on the horizon, it looks like wearable computing is the wave of the future. Rather than its first wearable computing product being as complicated as what is essentially an augmented reality headset, Apple could ease into the scene by first testing the market with a wearable wrist-computer.

As for when — or even if — Apple will attempt to make our wrists a place where computers reside, who knows. The technology is already here, though, so if Apple is serious about the endeavor, it doesn't have to be too far off.